

Christopher Musco

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Academic Positions

New York University

Assistant Professor, Tandon School of Engineering
Department of Computer Science and Engineering

New York, NY

Starting 2019

Princeton University

Research Instructor, Department of Computer Science

Princeton, NJ

2018 – present

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Research and Teaching Assistant, Theory of Computation Group

Cambridge, MA

2013 – 2018

Yahoo Labs

Research Intern, Scalable Machine Learning Group

New York, NY

Summer 2015

Research Areas

foundations of data science • scalable machine learning • numerical linear algebra • theory of algorithms
randomization • dimensionality reduction • sketching & streaming • spectral graph algorithms • optimization

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Cambridge, MA

2013 – 2018

Advisor: Jonathan Kelner

Thesis: Faster Linear Algebra for Data Analysis and Machine Learning

M.S. Thesis: Dimensionality Reduction for Sparse and Structured Matrices

Yale University

B.S. in Applied Mathematics, B.S. in Computer Science

New Haven, CT

2008 – 2012

Publications

Authors appear in alphabetical order, in the tradition of mathematics and theoretical computer science.

Sample Efficient Toeplitz Covariance Estimation. Yonina Eldar, Jerry Li, Cameron Musco, and Christopher Musco. *In submission.* 2019.

Low-Rank Approximation from Communication Complexity. Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco, David Woodruff. *In submission.* 2019.

Faster Spectral Sparsification in Dynamic Streams. Michael Kapralov, Aida Mousavifar, Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco, Navid Nouri. *In submission.* 2019.

A Universal Sampling Method for Reconstructing Signals with Simple Fourier Transforms. Haim Avron, Michael Kapralov, Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco, Ameya Velingker, Amir Zandieh. *ACM Symposium on Theory of Computing (STOC)* 2019.

Learning Networks from Random Walk-Based Node Similarities. Jeremy Hoskins, Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco, Charalampos Tsourakakis. *Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)* 2018.

Eigenvector Computation and Community Detection in Asynchronous Gossip Models. Frederik Mallmann-Trenn, Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco. *International Colloquium on Automata, Languages, and Programming (ICALP)* 2018.

Minimizing Polarization and Disagreement in Social Networks. Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco and Charalampos Tsourakakis. *The Web Conference (WWW)* 2018.

Stability of the Lanczos Method for Matrix Function Approximation. Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco, Aaron Sidford. *ACM-SIAM Symposium on Discrete Algorithms (SODA)* 2018.

Recursive Sampling for the Nyström Method. Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco. *Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)* 2017.

Random Fourier Features for Kernel Ridge Regression: Approximation Bounds and Statistical Guarantees. Haim Avron, Michael Kapralov, Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco, Ameya Velingker, Amir Zandieh. *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)* 2017.

Input Sparsity Time Low-Rank Approximation via Ridge Leverage Score Sampling. Michael B. Cohen, Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco. *ACM-SIAM Symposium on Discrete Algorithms (SODA)* 2017.

Determining Tournament Payout Structures for Daily Fantasy Sports. Christopher Musco, Maxim Sviridenko, Justin Thaler. *SIAM Algorithm Engineering and Experiments (ALENEX)* 2017.

Principal Component Projection Without Principal Component Analysis. Roy Frostig, Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco, Aaron Sidford. *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)* 2016.

Randomized Block Krylov Methods for Stronger and Faster Approximate Singular Value Decomposition. Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco. *Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)* 2015. Invited for full oral presentation (1 of 15 out of 403 accepted papers). Also presented at the 2016 Copper Mountain Conference on Iterative Methods

Dimensionality Reduction for K-Means Clustering and Low Rank Approximation. Michael B. Cohen, Samuel Elder, Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco, Madalina Persu. *ACM Symposium on Theory of Computing (STOC)* 2015.

Principled Sampling for Anomaly Detection. Brendan Juba, Fan Long, Christopher Musco, Stelios Sidiroglou-Douskos, Martin Rinard. *Network and Distributed System Security Symposium (NDSS)* 2015.

Uniform Sampling for Matrix Approximation. Michael B. Cohen, Yin Tat Lee, Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco, Richard Peng, Aaron Sidford. *Innovations in Theoretical Computer Science (ITCS)* 2015.

Single Pass Spectral Sparsification in Dynamic Streams. Michael Kapralov, Yin Tat Lee, Cameron Musco, Christopher Musco, Aaron Sidford. *IEEE Symposium on Foundations of Computer Science (FOCS)* 2014, Special Issue SIAM Journal on Computing 2017.

Teaching

Algorithmic Machine Learning and Data Science (NYU CS-GY 9223I)

Course Instructor

Fall 2019

Advanced Algorithm Design (Princeton COS 521)

Course Instructor

Fall 2018

Advanced Algorithms (MIT 6.854/18.415)

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2016

Technical Communication Skills for Graduate Students (MIT 6.S977)

Workshop Leader

Spring 2016

Introduction to Computer Science (Yale CPSC-201)

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2012

Introduction to Programming (Yale CPSC-112)

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2011

Mentorship and Outreach

SIAM/MathWorks Math Modeling Challenge

Judging and support

2018 – present

Serve as a judge for SIAM's annual math modeling competition, which gives high school students an opportunity to apply mathematics, statistics, and data science to a real-world problem. Score student reports, provide feedback, and help with various tasks like problem writing.

MIT Graduate Communication Lab

Communication Adviser

2015 – 2018

Helped to establish an EECS Communication Lab to provide over 700 graduate students with support in academic writing, oral presentation, job applications, and generally, in communicating effectively. Offered feedback, guidance, and coaching to individual students during weekly office hours.

CSAIL Algorithms Office Hours

Member

2016 – 2018

Advised researchers, generally in applied fields, on framing and solving algorithmic problems arising in their work.

Research Science Institute at MIT

Summer Research Adviser

2014

Primary supervisor for a high school student participating in the prestigious RSI summer research program. Advisee's project, "Relaxation of a Concurrent Disjoint-Set", was selected as one of 10 program finalists.

Talks and Presentations

Learning Signals with Simple Fourier transforms

Columbia University, Theory Seminar

Oct. 2018

UC Berkeley, Simons Institute Workshop

Sept. 2018

Princeton University, Theory Seminar

Sept. 2018

The Lanczos Method in Data Science: Challenges and Opportunities

Georgetown University, CS Seminar

Feb. 2018

Symposium on Discrete Algorithms (SODA)

Jan. 2018

Unifying Random Fourier Features and Leverage Scores for Kernel Matrix Approximation

Institute for Advanced Study, Computer Science and Discrete Mathematics Seminar

Feb. 2018

Harvard University, guest lecture in "Sketching Algorithms for Big Data"

Nov. 2017

Microsoft Research, Redmond

Sept. 2017

Sketching and Sampling Methods for Large Scale Linear Algebra

Twitter, Cambridge

July 2017

Recursive Sampling for the Nyström Method

Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) poster session

Dec. 2017

New England Machine Learning Day poster session

May 2017

Algorithms for Determining Tournament Payout Structures

Meeting on Algorithm Engineering and Experiments (ALENEX)

Jan. 2017

Introduction to Linear Sketching

MIT, Theory Retreat	<i>Sept. 2016</i>
Principal Component Projection without Principal Component Analysis	
International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)	<i>June 2016</i>
Ridge Leverage Score Sampling	
National Institute of Informatics, Shonan Meeting	<i>July 2016</i>
MIT, Algorithms & Complexity Seminar	<i>July 2016</i>
University of Utah, Data Group Meeting	<i>Jan. 2016</i>
Randomized Block Krylov Methods	
Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) poster session	<i>Dec. 2015</i>
Large Scale Column Subset Selection	
Yahoo Labs, Science Week poster session	<i>July 2015</i>
Dimensionality Reduction for k-Means Clustering	
IBM T.J. Watson, Mathematical Sciences research seminar	<i>Aug. 2015</i>
Symposium on Theory of Computing (STOC)	<i>June 2015</i>
MIT, Theory Lunch	<i>June 2014</i>
Principled Sampling for Anomaly Detection	
MIT, Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency site visit	<i>Mar. 2015</i>
Network and Distributed System Security Symposium (NDSS)	<i>Feb. 2015</i>
Uniform Sampling for Matrix Approximation	
Yahoo Labs, Scalable Machine Learning research seminar	<i>June 2015</i>
Single Pass Spectral Sparsification in Dynamic Streams	
MIT, Annual Sublinear Algorithms Day poster session	<i>Apr. 2015</i>
Harvard University, Theory Seminar	<i>Nov. 2014</i>
Foundations of Computer Science (FOCS)	<i>Oct. 2014</i>

Service

Conference Programming.....	
NeurIPS 2019 Area Chair	
Conference Reviewing.....	
COLT (2016, 2018, 2019), ESA (2015, 2017), FOCS (2015,2018), ICALP (2015, 2017, 2018), ICML (2018, 2019) ITCS (2018), IWOCA (2018), NeurIPS (2015, 2016, 2017, 2018), NDSS (2015), RANDOM (2017, 2018), STACS (2018), SODA (2016, 2017, 2018, 2019), STOC (2018, 2019), WALCOM (2018)	
Journal Reviewing.....	
SIAM Journal on Matrix Analysis and Applications (2016, 2017), SIAM Journal on Scientific Computing (2019), Science Advances (2018), Mathematical Programming (2018), IEEE Transactions on Signal Processing (2016, 2017, 2018), Journal of Machine Learning Research (2018, 2019), Advances in Data Analysis and Classification (2018), IEEE Transactions on Knowledge and Data Engineering (2017)	
Grants Panels.....	
NSF Division of Information and Intelligent Systems (2019)	
Notables.....	
ICML 2018 Outstanding Reviewer	

Other Research Experience

UC Berkeley, Simons Institute for the Theory of Computing

Invited participant

2018

Workshop on Randomized Numerical Linear Algebra and Applications.

Japan National Institute of Informatics

Invited participant

2016

Shonan meeting on Recent Advances in Randomized Numerical Linear Algebra.

Honors and Awards

National Science Foundation

2014-2017

Graduate Research Fellowship, recipient.

Yale University

2012

Cum Laude, Distinction in Both Majors.

Grants and Funding

Travel Awards.....

SIAM Early Career 2019, NeurIPS 2018, NeurIPS 2015

Other Professional Experience

Redfin

Seattle, WA

Software Engineer, Data Team

2012 – 2014

Developed backend Java infrastructure for internet-powered real estate startup. Incorporated large-scale machine learning algorithms into production code. Managed three interns and onboarded four new-hires.

Elysium Digital

Cambridge, MA

Summer Consultant

2011

Provided technical expertise in software patent cases at leading litigation consulting company.

Amicus

New Haven, CT

Software Developer

2010 – 2011

Built applications for political campaign management and social fundraising at an early-stage startup that went on to raise 4 million dollars in seed funding.